INTENTIONAL STRATEGIES FOR RESOLUTION

TOP FOUR LOSING STRATEGIES and THEIR ANTIDOTES:

Criticism....Lead with your need, intentional vulnerable conversation: *When,Then,This*
Defensiveness: Be *curious*, acknowledge, take responsibility by being RESPONSIVE
Contempt: Build a culture of *appreciation*
Stonewalling: Take an *intentional break*! (See below)

Some Important Cardinal Points:

* *The Map is not the Territory.*
* *People are not problems, problems are problems.*
* *You are not responsible for your partners emotions, you are* **responsible** *to* **respond**.
* *Emotion is data, not direction.*
* *Love is not a feeling, it's what you choose to do intentionally.*

Here is the part about emotional flooding and how to use the *art of intention* to take a break. If you are triggered and/or flooded with emotion in any discussions, it's time to **take a break** and do some **physiological self-soothing**.

THE BREAK PROTOCOL: STOP, DROP & ROLL

The first part of the antidote to experiencing this unpleasantness is to **STOP the discussion**. Let each other know when you're feeling overwhelmed, and say that you need to take a break (put your hand over your own chest). **Remember, no one puts anyone else in time out, we out ourselves in time out**. Attempts to continue will not make productive headway for either of you, but rather will intensify your shared conflict and emotional distress.

[GET AWAY FROM EACH OTHER]

The second step is to **practice physiological self soothing** – for at least twenty minutes, since it will take that much time for your bodies to physiologically calm down and **DROP** your heart rates. Ruminating will add things worse. Find what works for you! Go for a fast walk, run or workout. Do push-ups or jump rope. The key is to match your heart rates and at the same time redirecting your thoughts away from the conflict (headphones, tv, distractions).

[YOU NEEDS AND A-PLAN, B-PLAN, C-PLAN]

The third step is **ROLL into a responsive attitude and after 20 minutes, whomever initiated the break is responsible for coming back to make a plan** for when you might try to talk about this again, especially if 'right now' isn't going to work. Some conversations can resume after 20 minutes, some cannot. The rule of thumb here is to not let this go unresolved for more than 24 hours. But planning an **INTENTIONAL CONVERSATION** to try talk again let's everyone know (the pursuer & the avoider) that the intention is not to ignore our need to resolve things.

[Start with "Thank you for letting me take a break"]

Intentional conversations: by invitation, one subject at a time, we know when its going to end.

If when you talk again, you get flooded again.....**go back to #1! Rinse and repeat.**

Over time, this can become a **ritual** of how you as a couple deal with conflict and your partners need for resolution. It does absolutely no good to scream and yell and use short-term anger release to solve your problems. In fact, research shows us that it will just get worse.